

Throughout the semesters in the Clinical Mental Health Department, I have been able to acknowledge how important following ethical guidelines and legal concerns is in this field. Researching organizations such as the American Counseling Association and Texas Counseling Association encouraged me to continue researching and engaging on ethical frameworks that guide a licensed professional counselor throughout their career. Holding a License to be a Professional Counselor comes with many responsibilities. One of the main responsibilities as a professional is to maintain client confidentiality and private records while providing a safe space where clients are able to express and process difficult experiences and/or emotions.

Moreover, I have completed a Mandatory Reporting Community Response training that demonstrated my commitment in understanding and following legal responsibilities along with the duty to protect clients that are a danger to themselves or others to ensure client welfare. After this training, I realized how important it is to continuously participate in the system by following ethical codes and advocate for counselors to have access to resources that help us better understand the legal system and effectively navigate it when working with clients. However, the Case Study Analysis work, where I have practiced examining counseling scenarios with my peers and identifying whether they align with the ACA code of ethics responsibilities has helped me develop skills that have been useful at my clinical site. Through this coursework, I was able to develop skills that help analyze a case through ethical reasoning and decision-making process. I have learned to think critically about the ethical implications while being aware of confidentiality, boundaries, and client welfare. This experience has helped me acknowledge the importance in recognizing ethical dilemmas and making ethical-decisions that protect clients.